

StepCat

Payout Calculator

Quick Start Guide

App v253.0 and Profitability Workbook v253.0

Estimate payouts, record completed results, and copy exact rows into the matching workbook.

Release note

As of August 4, 2026, v253.0 is the recommended Google Sheets workbook. It corrects missing N-Z calculations when a whole Game Records row is inserted later, such as when adding a forgotten game. Users of earlier versions should create a new v253.0 copy and transfer populated A5:M values only.

This guide is for StepCat users. It explains the current app and workbook workflow without developer-facing implementation notes.

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Choose Entry Mode (Step 1), confirm Membership Type (Step 2), complete Game Entry (Step 3), then use Calculate Result (Step 4). Tap Show Optional Fields only for names, dates, payment labels, or other optional record details.

1. Follow the four-step entry sequence

Entry Mode is Step 1. Gold marks the single current action, green marks a completed step, and locked steps remain neutral. Choose Estimate for a projection or Finalized for a completed challenge. Membership Type is Step 2: it stays dimmed until Step 1 is confirmed, then receives a gold edge until Member or Non-Member is selected. During Step 3, the gold cue advances to the first incomplete required field. When the entry is ready, Step 4 receives the gold edge.

Entry Mode is Step 1 and begins the workflow.

Membership Type is Step 2 and is required before calculation.

Membership math

Member uses the full Gross Pot. Non-Member uses the adjusted pot after the 15% deduction. Show Math explains the active calculation.

Remember Entry Mode and Remember Membership are optional Settings. When either is off, StepCat intentionally asks for a fresh selection after refresh or reopening.

2. Complete Game Entry (Step 3)

Estimate

- Gross Pot — Required in Estimate; Optional in Finalized.
- Entry Fee
- Eligible Players — Required in Estimate; Optional in Finalized.

Total Players — Optional. When entered, it supports eliminated-player and elimination-rate calculations.

Finalized

- Entry Fee
- Final Earned / Chips — Required in Finalized unless Disqualified is selected.

Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee appears immediately before Final Earned. It is gray when unavailable, muted amber when available and off, and red when selected. Turning it on sets Final Earned to zero and locks the field for the current result.

Disqualified is off and Final Earned remains available.

Final Earned records the total returned, not profit alone.

Free Game rule

A Free Game must have a \$0 Entry Fee. StepCat blocks a Free Game with a paid fee in both Estimate and Finalized modes. A \$0 entry is recorded as Free Game.

3. Show Optional Fields only when needed

Game Entry contains the calculation fields. Optional Fields contains optional game and workbook information. When closed, its helper describes the extra details available. When opened, the control changes to Hide Optional Fields and the helper changes to Collapse the optional information shown below.

- Game Name
- Game Start Date and Game End Date
- Date Format — a web setting that controls copied date display; it is not a Required or Optional record field.
- Payment / Record Type
- Optional statistics when available
- Notes

Optional Fields opened with state-specific Hide helper text.

Calculate & Save validates and stores one result.

Notes can store unusual entry details or a cash-and-points breakdown.

Drawer behavior

Default-open Settings apply when StepCat loads or refreshes. They do not override a drawer that you manually opened or closed during the current session.

4. Calculate Result (Step 4), save, and understand the result

After completing Game Entry (Step 3), use Calculate Result (Step 4) and tap Calculate & Save. The readiness notice appears above Calculate & Save. StepCat scrolls to the first invalid field when correction is needed. A successful save clears the completed draft so it does not return as unfinished work.

Result	Meaning
Profit	Final Earned is greater than Entry Fee. Profit is the difference.
Draw	A normal completed return at or below Entry Fee. Net Profit is \$0.00.
Disqualified	A paid entry loses the full Entry Fee. Free Games record the status without a monetary loss.
Free Game	Return is recorded as chips or game credit. Cash Net Profit is \$0.00 and ROI is N/A.
Estimate	Projection only. Accounting Result and ROI remain N/A until finalized.

Newest saved Estimate with a Finalize This Estimate action.

Finalized Saved History card with result and accounting values.

5. Use Saved History and SC Record IDs

Saved History persists on the device. Copy All Sheet Rows remains the primary action; copy guidance appears next, followed by Restore History and Clear History as maintenance controls. Each record receives a permanent, non-editable SC Record ID such as SC-0023. The ID identifies the app record; it is not a workbook row number.

Device storage: StepCat's Saved History, settings, and unfinished Game Entry fields remain in the current browser and device. They do not automatically transfer to another phone, tablet, computer, browser, or browser profile.

For cross-device access, save completed records to the same Google Sheet and open that Sheet from the other device.

- Named records display the SC ID as small secondary text.
- An unnamed record uses a fallback such as Unnamed Game - SC-0023.
- The same ID remains through Estimate finalization, editing, deletion Undo, and restoration.
- Deleted IDs are not reused or renumbered.
- Copy This Sheet Row copies one record; Copy All Sheet Rows copies all saved records without headers.

Copy This Sheet Row prepares the exact A-M record values.

Deletion and restoration

Individual Delete offers a short Undo action. Restore History is a separate backup operation and warns before replacing non-empty current history.

6. Finalize an Estimate in place

Use Finalize This Estimate when a projected challenge ends. StepCat updates the same Saved History item instead of creating a duplicate. Its SC Record ID, original order, Gross Pot, Entry Fee, player counts, Membership Type, and Payment / Record Type remain attached to the record.

Enter the completed Final Earned / Chips and any optional final details.

- The Saved History count does not increase.
- The card changes from Estimate to Finalized in its original position.
- StepCat scrolls to the record that was actually updated.
- The original Estimated Earned and the difference from Estimate remain visible when available.

Workbook update

After finalizing an Estimate, copy the finalized A-M row over that game's existing A-M workbook row. Do not add a second workbook row for the same game.

7. Copy records into the workbook

The app copies input values only. In v253.0, columns A-M are inputs and protected expanding formulas calculate N-Z automatically. Never paste into N-Z.

The workbook can also be used without the StepCat calculator. Open the same Google Sheet on any device signed into the same Google account, enter or paste record values in A-M, and leave N-Z untouched. The workbook calculates its own results and reports; StepCat is an optional guided-entry and row-copying companion.

Only records already entered in the Google Sheet are available across devices. An unfinished StepCat form, local settings, and Saved History do not transfer automatically.

1. Open Game Records in the StepCat workbook.
2. Tap the first empty cell in column A, such as A5 in a blank workbook.
3. Tap Copy This Sheet Row in StepCat, or Copy All Sheet Rows for the full history.
4. Paste into the selected column-A cell.
5. Check that the row appears across A-M and that N-Z calculates automatically.

Game Records input columns begin at A-M.

Formula columns N-Z calculate automatically and should not be edited.

Do not enter cell-edit mode

Select the cell itself before pasting. Pasting while editing inside a cell can place the entire copied row into one cell.

8. Review workbook reports

The workbook uses the copied A-M values to calculate accounting fields, review data, and build report sheets. Estimate rows remain projections until finalized.

Record Review summarizes review status and points to fields that need attention.

Summary presents totals and result counts.

Best Results highlights top completed records.

Workbook comparisons

Game Comparisons groups completed records for comparison.

Older invalid rows

Record Review flags Free Game rows with a non-zero Entry Fee. Valid Free Games with a \$0 Entry Fee are treated normally.

9. Personalize Settings safely

All ordinary setting changes save automatically. The X closes Settings; it is not a Save button. Restore Defaults is the one bulk action that requires confirmation.

- Entry Preferences: remember Entry Mode, Membership Type, Payment / Record Type, unfinished Game Entry inputs, and the \$0 Entry Fee warning.
- Section Display & Starting State: choose which sections are visible and which start open after load or refresh.
- Help & Guides: remember guide progress.
- Haptic Feedback & Feedback: choose Off, Low, or High vibration feedback. The main Write Feedback action uses the same orange gradient and light text as Show Math, with its title and helper text centered at every phone width.

Haptic Feedback appears before Help & Guides, and all ordinary setting changes save automatically.

Restore Defaults

Confirming Restore Defaults returns all app settings, including Haptic Feedback, to the original defaults. Haptic Feedback returns to Low. Saved History and workbook records are not deleted.

10. Find Help & Resources

Help & Resources places destinations first. Create My Google Sheets Copy opens the supported v253.0 workbook, and Move your records opens a compact transfer guide. Every Quick Explanation header also includes a short helper line describing what opens beneath it. Workbook & Copying also explains direct workbook entry, cross-device use through Google Sheets, and the device-local limits of StepCat Saved History.

- Open Quick Start Guide
- Open Full Documentation
- Create My Google Sheets Copy
- Move Existing Records
- Quick Start PDF
- Editable DOCX
- Rules & Troubleshooting
- Spreadsheet Copy Help
- Installation & Shortcuts
- Write Feedback

Help & Resources uses lighter Expand/Collapse controls, short helper descriptions under every Quick Explanation title, and consistent subsection headers for guides, troubleshooting, downloads, installation, and feedback.

11. Install StepCat or create a shortcut

Installation requires the hosted StepCat page and a supported browser. The main information button opens a compact dialog with X and Close controls, so users return to the same place on the main page.

The Install StepCat card reports the current installation state. Its information button explains installation and shortcut alternatives without opening Help & Resources.

Android Chrome may offer Install app or Add to Home screen.

Confirm installation when the browser provides the prompt.

Installation and shortcut information opens in a compact dialog with X and Close controls.

Installed StepCat icon on the device home screen.

Hosted release check

After uploading the refreshed v253.0 package, close open StepCat tabs and the installed app, then reopen the hosted site. Confirm the visible app version is v253.0, the August 5 documentation-refresh service-worker cache is active, and the Google Sheets button opens the public v253.0 copy screen.

12. Send feedback

Write Feedback is available from the main page and Help & Resources. The main-page button centers its title and helper text. Enter a message, continue to the email app, and review the prepared recipient, subject, and message before sending.

*Enter feedback inside StepCat.**Review the prepared email before sending.*

13. Migrate old workbook data

Simple migration

Copy populated Game Records A5:M values into v253.0 A5. Use Paste special → Values only on a computer. Regular Paste is acceptable on mobile when only A-M are copied; minor appearance differences can be corrected later.

1. Make a backup copy of the old workbook.
2. Open the old workbook's Game Records sheet.
3. Select A5:M[last used row]. Example: A5:M54.
4. Copy the selected range.
5. **Create a new v253.0 Google Sheets copy, then select Game Records cell A5.**
6. **On a computer, use Paste special → Values only. On a phone or tablet, regular Paste is acceptable when only A-M are copied.**
7. **Confirm the first and last records appear once, the record count agrees, and N-Z calculations appear automatically.**
 - Do not copy rows 1-4.
 - Do not copy the column headings.
 - Do not copy columns N-Z.
 - Do not copy or replace whole sheets.
 - Existing named workbook rows do not need SC Record IDs.

14. Troubleshooting and rules

Issue	What to do
Calculate does not continue	Correct the highlighted field. StepCat scrolls to the first blocking error.
Free Game fee is rejected	Set Entry Fee to 0 or use another Payment / Record Type.
Membership or Entry Mode reset	Enable the corresponding Remember setting, or make a fresh selection.
Saved entry returned as a draft	Confirm the hosted page shows v253.0 and the August 5 service worker. Successful saves clear completed draft storage.
Disqualified returned after reopening	v253.0 never restores Disqualified through draft recovery. Start a fresh entry and confirm the active v253.0 release.
Copied row did not calculate	Paste into the column-A cell only. Protected N-Z calculations populate automatically.
Installation unavailable	Use the hosted page in a supported browser, or follow Add to Home Screen guidance.
Drawer changed after Settings	v253.0 preserves live drawer state; startup defaults apply only after load or refresh.
Switching devices	Open the same Google Sheet on the other device. Records already entered in the Sheet are available there. StepCat Saved History, settings, and unfinished fields remain on the original browser/device and must be copied to the Sheet before switching.

Unsaved-entry protection

Clear Entry and Start New Entry warn before discarding meaningful unfinished content. Continue Editing is the safe default.

For the complete reference, open Full Documentation from Help & Resources. As of August 4, 2026, v253.0 is the recommended Google Sheets workbook because it corrects calculations after inserting a forgotten Game Records row. Transfer populated A-M values only; existing records do not need to be retyped.